

to embrace the queen!

"When the king heard this, he jumped up and shouted, 'Gorambha! Is that true? Has Dantila really embraced the queen?'

— 'Master,' replied Gorambha, 'I was gambling all night and didn't sleep at all. This morning I feel drowsy. I really don't know what I've been saying.'

"Jealous, the king thought to himself, 'Yes! The servant Gorambha is allowed to go about freely in the palace and so is Dantila. It is quite possible that Gorambha has seen Dantila embracing my queen, for:

"What a man ponders over, sees or performs
During the day,
He will mutter in his dreams."

— 'And there is no doubt about it when a woman is involved. She smiles at one man, with half-opened lips, throws a little remark at another, at the same time flirting with the third, her eyes half-closed, whilst in her heart she dreams of yet another man, the one she loves. Who can depend on the love of such a woman, with eyebrows like the bows of an archer? The man who thinks that a woman loves him, is a fool. He falls into her trap — she'll treat him like a toy.'

"The king's thoughts were so troubled that, from that day onward, he withdrew his favours from Dantila and, what is more, he forbade him even to enter the palace. Dantila was astounded to see this sudden change in the king's attitude and said to himself, 'It's true what they say:

"Has anyone heard of
A crow that is clean,
A gambler who is honest,
A snake that forgives,
A passionate woman who is calm,
An impotent man who is brave,
A drunkard with discrimination,
Or the friendship of a king."

— 'Even in my dreams, I have done no harm to anyone,